

parts loosely arranged around themes of parenting, adoption, race, and healing conversations. These intimate essays celebrate the social and emotional impact of shared reading or “book bonding,” a phrase coined by Lambert when she was an educator at the Eric Carle Museum of Picture Book Art. “Time and again, shared reading has forged a common ground for my children and me as we reach toward each other across the distances between us.” Lambert’s deeply personal writing reflects on the impact of books and reading on her relationships with her children in their transracial, blended family. (*Unidentified Suburban Object* helped Lambert’s children talk about their experiences as children of color; *The Book of Mistakes* spoke to a perfectionist daughter.) The author’s efforts toward inclusion and revelation highlight a wide variety of books, valuable as an introduction to inclusive reading. A booklist is included, as is an afterword from Lambert’s son. It is in Lambert’s reflections on her family’s own book bonding experiences that her essays become invitations to insight. Lambert states her position clearly: “Can storytime change the world? I think it can—by asserting messages of equity, inclusion, empathy, and pride, all while creating shared spaces in which to have brave conversations that envision a safer, more humane world for all.” **VERDICT** Recommended. Sharing books can help make sense of an often-confusing world, and this title is a good place to begin. —Janice M. Del Negro

MAXWELL, Lucas. *Let’s Roll: A Guide to Setting up Tabletop Role-Playing Games in Your School or Public Library.* 140p. Facet. Apr. 2023. pap. \$37.99. ISBN 9781783306138.

Maxwell’s book provides ample resources and support material for library staff who are entirely new to the world of TTRPGs (Tabletop Role-Playing Games), as well as those who are generally familiar with gaming but concerned about some aspect of launching an RPG programming initiative. This title addresses specific hurdles, including finding institutional support, marketing to patrons, and managing a chaotic program session. Supplemental materials include a glossary of common terms, a sample program proposal, case studies from school and public librarians, several recommended reading lists, and brief reviews of a number of simple gateway RPGs that can be learned and played by librarians and patrons with minimal preparation or expertise. This is a

well-organized title with very specific strategies for success and a gentle, conversational tone. At times it leans heavily into the personal experiences of the author, a high school librarian, but it does include a number of case study statements from other librarians running TTRPGs in varied library settings and with a range of age groups. **VERDICT** A slim but comprehensive title with an earnest and encouraging authorial voice. Recommended for any school or public library professional who has felt trepidation about introducing an RPG program.—Anne Nelson

★ **MUHAMMAD, Gholdy.** *Unearthing Joy: A Guide to Culturally and Historically Responsive Teaching and Learning.* 224p. Scholastic Professional. Feb. 2023. pap. \$36.99. ISBN 9781338856606.

In this stirring follow-up to *Cultivating Genius*, Muhammad builds upon the framework she introduced therein, adding the pursuit of joy to the four previously identified pursuits of identity; skills; intellect; and criticality, or “developing the ability to read texts to understand power, authority, and anti-oppression.” It is through these pursuits, she argues, that educators can work toward making teaching and learning truly student-centered. The author begins by providing historical context for her framework, relying on the literary and educational practices of Black ancestors. From there, she offers practical examples and applications of the framework, including suggested texts, questions for reflection, and sample lesson plans. Muhammad emphasizes the importance of school and district stakeholders undertaking this work in community with one another. The book is firmly grounded in the need for genius, justice, and joy in education, but is also an example of what that can look like; woven throughout the text are poems, artwork, coloring pages, and curated playlists that encourage joy, creativity, and deep reflection. While the author does provide some discussion of her previous work, it is recommended that readers begin with *Cultivating Genius*. **VERDICT** Practical, inspiring, and joyous all at once. Outstanding and highly recommended!—Lauren Strohecker

ROGERS-WHITEHEAD, Carrie & Vanessa Monterosa. *Deepening Digital Citizenship: A Guide to Systemwide Policy and Practice.* 168p. ISTE. Mar. 2023. pap. \$39.99. ISBN 9781564849663.

Digital citizenship, a nebulous and slippery topic, is often difficult for teachers and

librarians to implement. This text expounds on how to introduce digital citizenship from the top down and encourages districts to find out what they define as digital scholarship, what their needs are, and how to address the needs for the population they serve. For instance, if they have a large refugee population, or a strong neurodivergent contingent, districts can assess their needs and put goals in place for educators and leaders, and for what the students need at the practical level. The lens first focuses on how educational leaders can make systemwide change; then, on how to educate those who will implement the curriculum and what that looks like at the ground level. The authors encourage educators to analyze what their district or school needs and to work with every student in mind. Though the book is academic, it lacks the oppressiveness of academic writing. Packed with resources, standards, questions to help educators tailor their programs, and examples including case studies, this book attempts to demystify the topic of digital citizenship and what that means to education leaders as they sit down and try to address the needs of a district, school, or students. **VERDICT** Perfect for librarians who wear many hats and need to analyze the implementation of digital citizenship from every angle, as well as for educators who have to make district-wide decisions that impact many students. —Rachel Joiner

VOELS, Sarah. *Auditing Diversity in Library Collections.* 160p. Libraries Unlimited. Aug. 2022. pap. \$60. ISBN 9781440878749.

An insightful book packed with helpful and timely information to aid librarians and library professionals who may be envisaging a diversity audit of their library collection. Voels begins by providing an overview of the history of publishing in relation to equity, diversity, and inclusion; the history of diversity audits; and how audits have impacted her library’s collection. Other chapters discuss audits done by public and school libraries across the country, flaws and limitations of audits, and how libraries have used audits to stimulate equity in other aspects, such as programming, instruction, and community relations. Each chapter ends with references, and an index and suggested resources are provided in the back of the book. A summary of audit advice from the libraries included in the book is also quite useful. **VERDICT** This informative and engaging book is a great choice for both library students and established public and school librarians.—Susan Ketcham

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